Boston Matrix — activity pack

1.3.3.1 Marketing mix and strategy · Unit 1 · Mr. Akram — Akademy

For each business, place the products into the matrix (star / cash cow / question mark / dog), then decide which to invest in and justify it. *Market clues are invented for this teaching activity, not verified business data.*

Answer key — indicative placements

Business	Star	Cash cow	Question mark	Dog
LEGO	Technic	City	DREAMZzz	Classic
Apple	Apple Watch	iPad	Vision Pro	HomePod
Coca-Cola	Zero Sugar	Original Coke	Costa RTD coffee	Regional Fanta
Samsung	Galaxy Z foldables	Televisions	Galaxy smart rings	Galaxy tablets
McDonald's	McCafé iced coffee	Big Mac	McPlant	Side salad

Key judgements

- **Is being a 'dog' enough reason to withdraw?** No — low share/growth doesn't prove it's unprofitable. It may serve loyal customers or support other sales. Check profit/contribution, avoidable costs and links to other products first.
- **How useful is the matrix?** A simple starting point for allocating investment and balancing the portfolio, but it ignores costs and profitability and is only a snapshot — combine it with financial data, market research and competitor information.